



MONITORS (CRT)

Everyone would like their favourite movies to come through in breath-taking colour on their PC monitors. Entertainment, designing and multimedia are the biggest things to hit the PC industry today. This year we tested just the 17-inch and the 19-inch monitors, with the 15-inch still surviving.

The BenQ v991 became the performance winner across monitors from more than 10 vendors. It's a 19-inch flat-screen CRT offering a large viewing area of 18 inches, or 47.5 cm. The high refresh rate produces flicker-free images, which makes it easy on the eyes. The diagonal dot pitch is an ultra-fine 0.25 mm. It also has an iScreen OSD control, allowing instant adjustment to the most suitable settings. This monitor is ideal for professionals who work at high resolutions.

Performance was amazingly good, and we saw it topping in four of the five tests we performed. It managed 23.25 out of 35 in the sharpness and resolution test, where all the other monitors were not able to cross 19. In the geometric test it tied for top spot with the LG Studioworks 900B, another good monitor.

BenQ v991

- + High resolution, great performance
- No extra accessories

Price: Rs 16,999

Contact: BenQ India Pvt Ltd

Phone: 022-2570 5231

Fax: 022-2570 5235

E-mail: salesenquiryin@benq.com

Reviewed in: July 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Sony Multiscan G520

2001: Samsung SyncMaster 955DF

The LG was able to get the better of this gem from BenQ only in the screen pixel resolution test.

The BenQ is ideal for page layout artists and those who use a lot of geometric drawings, as they will be able to see crisp images with minimal jagged-

WORTHY MENTIONS

LG Studioworks 900B

- + Decent performance
- Considerable ghosting and streaking

Price: Rs 14,200

Contact: LG Electronics India Pvt Ltd

Phone: 0120-256 0900

Fax: 0120-256 0940

E-mail: response@lgebuy.com

Reviewed in: July 2003

Compaq MV7500

- + Detachable speakers, calibration software
- No anti-glare coating

Price: Rs 12,000

Contact: AVI Electronics

Phone: 022-2646 5522

Fax: 022-2646 0347

E-mail: aviteam@vsnl.com

Reviewed in: July 2003

ness—even at high resolutions.

The three year on-site warranty is the clincher. The warranty ensures that you will never have the headache of carrying this monitor to a service centre, in the rare event of a component failure.

MONITORS (LCD)

The Sony SDM-N80 has a device termed the Media Engine. It has connecting points to the display card as well as to another digital display device. Inbuilt speakers on the side of the device add to the multimedia experience.

The LCD itself has a very stylish-looking OSD control panel on top of the screen. Support for USB is provided by a 2-port mini hub at the back. The recommended resolution is 1280 x 1024 at 60 Hz, with the maximum resolution supported being 1600 x 1200. The angle tilt can reach a maximum of 60 degrees, but there's hardly any height adjustment possible.

In the test we conducted using the Display Mate Video Edition software, the horizontal, vertical and diagonal lines were very sharp, but with a tinge of yellow. There was hardly any sign of streaking or ghosting, but there were dark corners. With hardly any flicker, almost perfect screen uniformity, and an absolute zero mirror reflection in the dark screen test, this LCD performs very well indeed. A separate test was conducted to check the pixel

SONY SDM-N80 18.1"

- + In-built speakers, 2-port USB hub, brightness/contrast adjustment according to ambient light, user sensor that switches off the LCD when no one's around

- A tinge of yellow visible

Price: Rs. 1,47,000

Contact: Rashi Peripherals

Phone: 022-2826 0258

Fax: 022-2822 1012

E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com

Reviewed in: December 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Samsung SyncMaster 171MP

2001: NA

persistence—this test indicates how good games and movies will look. The monitor passed the test wonderfully.

This monitor scores full marks for style, and will add a lot of appeal to any desk.

WORTHY MENTIONS

Samsung Syncmaster 171S

- + Can be used in landscape or portrait mode, height adjustment, wall mounting, best performance and best value in the 17-inch category

- Omission of DVI support

Price: Rs 42,000

Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd

Phone: 011-5151 1234

Fax: 011-5160 8820

E-mail: marketing@samsungindia.com

Reviewed in: February 2003

Sharp LL-T15G3

- + Very compact, auto gain can be set, best performance and best value in 15-inch category

- Performed poorly in OSD test

Price: Rs 19,200

Contact: Sharp India Ltd

Phone: 011-2643 1313

Fax: 011-2643 8748

E-mail: lcd@sharp-oa.com

Reviewed in: July 2003

